

manually start the SSL service and create an SSL certificate. Though it scored a zero in the virus test due to the lack of an anti-virus, it did well in the rest, especially in the speed and flood tests.

The software had all the minimal features we were looking for in all categories—the basic e-mailing, security and interface categories—and it scored an ace in each one of them!

Price: US\$110 (six users)
Web site: www.altn.com/products/default.asp?catalog%5Fname=Products&category%5Fname=Software&product%5Fid=MDaemon

- + Inbuilt EICAR test for anti-virus
- Web admin not installed by default

MDaemon	A-
Performance	★★★★★
Features	★★★★★
Ease of use	★★★★★

Merak Mail Lite 7.0.1

Our software of choice



A mail server that detects 14 out of the 22 infected e-mails in the virus test has to have some substance. The initial configuration is a simple, single-step process, where you need to specify a hostname, domain name, administrator username and an administrator password.

Merak Mail Lite has a conventional application-based interface that is quite similar to the browser-based admin interface. It had all the features we were looking for. Even if it did not have an inbuilt dialler, it integrated well with the one that comes with Windows. This software allows you to set size limits to data sent by a user, and the maximum number of messages sent by him or her per day. These little features help in maintaining decent manageable mail traffic on the Intranet.

It sends mails based on their waiting time in the queue. Using this feature, you can specify the maximum amount of time a message sits in the SMTP queue, before it dials out and goes on its way.

A new security technique, 'deny telnet access', does not allow a person to write to any server port using telnet.

Meanwhile, Merak Mail Lite excelled in identifying spam. It treated the first message in the 1,000-message flooding test as a regular e-mail, but marked the rest as spam.

Merak Mail Lite shows the amount of actual data transfer taking place in KB or MB. A system administrator can use this as an indicator to find out whether the software is actually working. The software bundles along goodies in the form of a calendaring server and an instant messaging server.

Thanks to this great mix of features, performance and ease of use, this software comes out tops. Merak Mail Lite 7.0.1 is definitely our recommendation.

Price: US\$99
Web site: www.icewarp.com/Products/Merak_Email_Server_Software

- + Deny telnet access; integrated anti-virus; mail sending based on waiting time
- No inbuilt dialler

Merak Mail Lite 7.0.1	A
Performance	★★★★★
Features	★★★★★
Ease of use	★★★★★

Office Mail 1.1j+

Light, very light

Office Mail is a mail server that provides just basic stuff such as downloading, storing and forwarding. It doesn't even act as a domain mail server.

It lost heavily on features. In the interface category, it just has one feature to boast about—the ability to create users. Anti-virus support, IP-based screening and SMTP authentication are the only features in the security category.

You have to specify each and every e-mail ID, messages to be downloaded from an external mail server. These IDs can be from any domain. Similarly, you can specify another

list of e-mail IDs, messages for which should arrive through the SMTP port, and be stored locally on the server. All e-mails, except for those specified on the list, will be forwarded to the external SMTP server. Messages pertaining to e-mail IDs in the list are stored in the corresponding local inboxes.

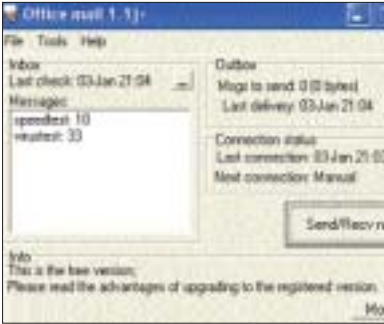
In performance, Office Mail is as good as Merak Mail and MDaemon. However, it doesn't allow multiple connections simultaneously, and hence slows down when the SMTP server is overloaded. Nevertheless, it did not defer incoming e-mails at any time, accepting the entire bulk in one go.

The big plus is that it's extremely light on system resources. With just two servers, POP3 and SMTP, Office Mail is a good product for a very small organisation, especially since it's free.

Price: Free
Web site: www.burrotech.com/office-mail.php

- + Light on resources; only two servers
- Lacks several features

Office Mail 1.1j+	B
Performance	★★★★★
Features	★★★★★
Ease of use	★★★★★



Office Mail shows the precise status of the POP3 and SMTP servers in a single window

Know Thy Domain!

Use the 'whois' service provided by Accredited Registrar Web sites such as www.godaddy.com to check for contact information associated with your domain. Normally, it's implemented using a textbox and a button. If the domain isn't in your name, then call the company that registered your domain, and set it right.

There have been instances where a middleman registers the domain for the client, and then keeps the ownership rights to some other company. If this happens, you hardly stand a chance of acquiring those rights again.

Most domain registration companies issue an administrator username and password. Use these to log in to a Web-based interface to manage domain details such as contact information, domain name server settings and password modification.